

CAROLINE MIEHE

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DAFRE, Celestijnenlaan 200E – box 2411, 3001 Leuven, Belgium • born on Sep 29, 1993, in Berlin, Germany

Mission statement Through randomized field experiments and primary data collection, I study how economic principles – such as decision-making under uncertainty and asymmetric information – can inform strategies to strengthen the resilience of communities confronting poverty and climate change in sub-Saharan Africa.

Education **KU Leuven, Belgium**
Doctor of Economics, 2019 – 2023
Ph.D. supervisor: Johan Swinnen

Master of Business Administration, 2017 – 2018
graduated with 87,75% (greatest distinction)

University of Potsdam, Germany
Bachelor of Business Administration, 2012 – 2016
graduated with 82% (great distinction)

Relevant working experience	2026 – now	Research associate	DAFRE, KU Leuven, Belgium
	2024 – 2026	Postdoctoral researcher	NOVAFRICA, Nova University Lisbon, Portugal
	2019 – 2023	Ph.D. candidate & teaching assistant	LICOS, KU Leuven, Belgium
	2022 – 2022	Research employee	DEC, Wageningen University, Netherlands
	2013 – 2015	Teaching assistant	University of Potsdam, Germany

Publications

Journal articles	Miehe, C., Nabwire, L., Sparrow, R., Spielman, D. J., & Van Campenhout, B. (2025). Miracle seeds: Biased expectations, complementary input use, and the dynamics of smallholder technology adoption. <i>Economic Development and Cultural Change</i> , 74(1), 305–334.
	De, A., Miehe, C., & Van Campenhout, B. (2024). Gender bias in customer perceptions: The case of agro-input dealers in Uganda. <i>Agricultural Systems</i> , 217, 103954.
	Mogues, T., Van Campenhout, B., Miehe, C., & Kabunga, N. (2023). The impact of community-based monitoring on public service delivery: A randomized control trial in Uganda. <i>World Development</i> , 172, 106374.
Policy report	Van Campenhout, B., Kabunga, N., Mogues, T., & Miehe, C. (2021). Community advocacy forums and public service delivery in Uganda. <i>3ie Impact Evaluation Report</i> 136.
Book chapter	Swinnen, J., Miehe, C., & Emmers, D. (2021). COVID-19 en voedselzekerheid. In B. Pattyn, & P. d’Hoine (Eds.), <i>Lessen voor de 21ste eeuw: Weten wat telt in tijden van crisis</i> (pp. 69–84). Leuven Univ. Press.

Media

- Caetano, P., Leeffers, S., Macdonald, J., Vicente, P. C., Miehe, C., & Calaim, N. (2025, October 22). Community action against floods: Climate adaptation in coastal Mozambique. *International Growth Centre Blog*.
- Miehe, C., Nabwire, L., Sparrow, R., Spielman, D. J., & Van Campenhout, B. (2025, May 21). How misinformation and mismatched expectations reduce adoption of improved seeds. *VoxDev Article*.
- Miehe, C., Nabwire, L., Sparrow, R., Spielman, D. J., & Van Campenhout, B. (2023, June 22). “Miracle seeds,” informational curses? The risk of high expectations for new agricultural technologies. *IFPRI Blog: Research Post*.
- De, A., Miehe, C., & Van Campenhout, B. (2023, March 17). This is a man’s world: Gendered perceptions of Ugandan agro-input dealers. *IFPRI Blog: Research Post*.
- Van Campenhout, B., Miehe, C., Spielman, D. J., & Sparrow, R. (2022, April 4). What changed when Ugandan farmers rated input quality and local vendor services. *The Conversation*.
- Van Campenhout, B., & Miehe, C. (2021, February 4). Does bottom-up monitoring improve public services? What we found in Uganda. *The Conversation*.

Conferences & seminars

HIVA Seminar at KU Leuven (2026 in Leuven, Belgium) • Spatio-Environmental Data in Economics (2026 in Lisbon, Portugal) • Great Lakes of Africa Centre (Institute of Development Policy) Seminar at University of Antwerp (2026, online) • Christmas Meeting of Belgian Economists (2025 in Brussels, Belgium) • EAAE Congress (2025 in Bonn, Germany) • Earth and Life Institute Seminar at UCLouvain (2025 in Louvain-la-Neuve, Belgium) • Development Economics Seminar at KU Leuven (2025 in Leuven, Belgium) • Lisbon Micro Group (2025 in Lisbon, Portugal) • Economics Seminar at Wageningen University (2025 in Wageningen, Netherlands) • Nova Economics Club (2024 in Lisbon, Portugal) • NOVAFRICA Conference (2024 in Lisbon, Portugal) • CSAE Conference (2023 in Oxford, UK) • NL-CGIAR Conference (2022, online) • ISSD Africa Synthesis Conference (2022 in Kigali, Rwanda) • AgEconMeeting (2022 in Göttingen, Germany) • Wageningen University EconMonday Seminar (2022 in Wageningen, Netherlands) • LICOS Seminar (2022 in Leuven, Belgium) • LICOS Ideas Exchange (2021 in Leuven, Belgium) • ASSA Annual Meeting (2021, online) • AAEA Annual Meeting (2020, online)

Projects & research funding

2026 – 2029	Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia: “Individual Call to Scientific Employment Stimulus” (postdoctoral fellowship)	Salary
2025 – 2028	Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia: “Urbanization meets the environment” with P. Vicente, S. Leeffers, & J. Macdonald	249,923 €
2025 – 2026	NL-CGIAR: “Optimizing performance of improved seed varieties for smallholder farmers in Uganda” with R. Sparrow	161,537 €
2019 – 2021	NL-CGIAR: “Policy and regulatory reform options for seed market development” with R. Sparrow, D. J. Spielman, B. Van Campenhout, & others	992,792 €

Peer reviews

Economica • NOVAFRICA Conference • American Journal of Agricultural Economics • Journal of the AAEA • XVIII Congress of the EAAE • PLOS ONE

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Teaching experience	2025 – 2025	<u>Development economics</u>	Nova Univ. Lisbon, Portugal
	2021 – 2023	<u>Introduction to the economics of development</u>	KU Leuven, Belgium
	2021 – 2023	<u>Development economics</u>	KU Leuven, Belgium
	2020 – 2021	<u>Lessons for the 21st century</u>	KU Leuven, Belgium
	2015 – 2015	<u>Introduction to controlling & cost accounting</u>	Univ. of Potsdam, Germany
	2013 – 2014	<u>Mathematics for economists I</u>	Univ. of Potsdam, Germany

Supervision & mentoring experience

Doctoral committee member: Emily ter Steeg (Wageningen Univ.)

Research assistant & intern supervisor: Theresa Vanwingh (KU Leuven), Maria Inês Jacob (Nova Univ. Lisbon), Marta Botelho (Nova Univ. Lisbon), Emma Prati (Wageningen Univ.), Isis Lodewijk (Wageningen Univ.), Nuno Calaim (Nova Univ. Lisbon)

Mentor in the NOVAFRICA mentorship program (Nova Univ. Lisbon)

Author of *R* and *GitHub* tutorials, onboarding guides for research assistants and interns, and fieldwork checklists

Bachelor's and Master's thesis supervisor

Field experience	Nov '25 Uganda	Focus group discussions to complement data from <u>Demand and supply factors constraining the sustainability of an efficient seed system</u>
	Jul–Aug '24 Mozambique	Design and implementation of intervention for <u>Urbanization meets the environment</u>
	Jan–Feb '22 Uganda	Midline data collection, intervention implementation for <u>Demand and supply factors constraining the sustainability of an efficient seed system</u>
	Apr–Jun '21 Uganda	Baseline data collection, intervention implementation for <u>Demand and supply factors constraining the sustainability of an efficient seed system</u>
	Aug '19 Uganda	Preparation of endline data collection for <u>Community advocacy forums and public service delivery</u>

Memberships	Since 2023	American Economic Association (AEA)
	Since 2023	European Economic Association (EEA)
	Since 2022	European Association of Agricultural Economists (EAAE)
	Since 2022	Agricultural Economics Society (AES)
	Since 2020	Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA)

Languages German (native) • English (fluent) • Dutch (fluent) • Spanish (basic)

Software R • LyX/LaTeX • GitHub • Microsoft Office

References	Johan Swinnen • Ph.D. supervisor IFPRI, KU Leuven email	Bjorn Van Campenhout • mentor IFPRI, KU Leuven email
	Pedro C. Vicente • supervisor Nova University Lisbon email	Robert Sparrow • former supervisor Wageningen University email